

Zhilingyun Zhang

PERSONAL INFORMATION

E-mail: zzlyiphone@icloud.com

Mobile: +1 213-791-6694

Location: Los Angeles, CA, 90017

Portfolio Website: <https://zzly07.github.io/>

EDUCATION

MFA at University of Southern California

09/2026 – Expected 05/2029

Major: Interactive Media & Game Design

BA at University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

09/2020 - 05/2025

Major: History, Economics, Minor: Game Studies and Design

GPA: 3.91/4.00

EXPERIENCE – INTERNSHIP

Beijing FN Game

10/2025 – 01/2026

Gameplay Developer Intern

- Developed a new 'last-man-standing' game mode for a large-space multiplayer VR title using Unity and C#.
- Implemented core gameplay systems for new mode, including a dynamically shrinking safe zone and a new revival mechanic.
- Integrated new game logic, UI, and states with the existing codebase, connecting them to the established network framework.
- Collaborated with designers to rapidly prototype, test, and debug new gameplay loops in a VR environment.

Shanghai 808 Game

07/2025 – 10/2025

Game Designer Intern

- Wrote complete narrative scripts (100+ lines of dialogue) to redirect the story, differentiating it from a previous company title.
- Designed and optimized new level flows to solve key spatial challenges, enabling 3 concurrent groups (15-21 total players) to navigate the 30-minute VR experience without conflict.
- Collaborated in a three-person design team to develop level layouts and narrative revisions, using flow diagrams to communicate changes to developers and artists.

Shanghai Huaqiang Equity Investment Management Co. LTD

05/2023 – 08/2023

Assistant Analyst

- Analyzed market trends and growth prospects across 5+ investment sectors and multiple target companies, presenting findings through data visualizations at weekly team meetings.
 - Collaborated with senior analysts to conduct interviews with executive boards of potential investment targets, gaining insights into their business strategies, operational efficiencies, and long-term growth plans.
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GAME DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE

Crease, Unity 3D.

09/2026 to Present

Position: Level Designer. A 50-person Advanced Game Project team at USC. A 3D flying puzzle-adventure game in which a daughter's letter, folded into a paper plane, journeys to reach her father. Designed and iterated on multiple level blockouts and contributed to future level ideation and iteration.

She Took That Away, Unity 3D.

09/2026

Personal Project. A first-person narrative exploration game, using a memory-switching mechanic and environmental storytelling to let players reconstruct a relationship through changes in a shared apartment. Link: <https://zzly.itch.io/she-took-that-away>

Bocchi the Spire, Mod.

05/2025 to 07/2025

Personal Project. A mod for Slay the Spire inspired by an anime called Bocchi the Rock. Designed a new character in game with multiple unique mechanics that were driven by the anime's characters, plots, and ideals it expressed. Reached 10,000+ subscribers on steam workshop. Link: <https://steamcommunity.com/sharedfiles/filedetails/?id=3529319023>

Wide Asleep, Unity 3D.

10/2024 to 11/2025

Position: Level and Gameplay Designer, Gameplay Developer. A first-person psychological horror game that is inspired by mental distress, using five senses as main mechanics for stealth and puzzle-solving, simulating experiences of sense deprivation.

Demo can be played here: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1WRaQo7KAQ1bxZdA0faS6riEHIHydYdph/view?usp=sharing>

PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

- Game Engine: Unity Engine, C#, Unreal Engine
- Version Control: Git, SVN, Perforce
- 2D Design Tool: Figma, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Lightroom
- Audio Tool: FMOD
- Language: English, Chinese